



IDS11074

Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 3:40 am CST on Thursday 20 August 2026
for the period until midnight CST Saturday 22 August 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A cold front clears to the east Wednesday evening. Weak troughs clip the southeast in a broad westerly flow on Thursday and Friday, as a ridge of high pressure is expected to approach South Australia from the west. The high centre is expected to linger over the state on the weekend.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southwesterly in the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon then decreasing to about 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Becoming cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots in the west during the morning. Winds turning southwesterly in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: West to southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres in the west. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to below 10 knots during the morning then becoming north to northeasterly during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Westerly 1.5 to 2.5 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then tending west to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable below 10 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.